THE INFORMATION SERVICE • TEXT-MODE EDITION

CLASSIC

CompuServe Simulator

USER MANUAL

Everything you need to make your first call: signing on, finding your way with GO commands, reading EasyPlex mail, joining the Forums, talking on the CB Simulator, and browsing the Data Libraries — all in the style of December 1988.

DECEMBER 1988 EDITION • VERSION 1.17.0

```
CompuServe Information Service

User ID: 70000,0001
Password:

Welcome to CompuServe!
Last access: 12/15/88  9:42 PM EST

Type GO START for three suggestions
tailored to your date.
```

Public Telnet: `compuserve-sim.duckdns.org:2323`

An independent historical simulation. Not affiliated with or endorsed by CompuServe, AOL, or their successors. All charges, orders, and reservations shown in the service are fictional.

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HOW TO USE THIS MANUAL

Commands you type appear in `MONOSPACE TYPE`, exactly as you should enter them. Type the command and press **Enter**. Capital letters do not matter — the service reads `go mail` and `GO MAIL` the same way. Boxes marked NOTE carry the shortcuts and cautions that save connect time, and the dark panels reproduce what the screen actually shows, so you can compare your terminal against the page.

New members should read Chapters 1 and 2, then take the guided tour: from any prompt, type `GO HELP`, choose **1 Instructions/User Information**, then **1 Tour/Find a Topic**, then **1 Tour**. The tour walks you through EasyPlex, a Forum, its Libraries, and the Activity Center, explaining the commands before each service opens.

A WORD ABOUT THE SIMULATION

This manual describes a faithful recreation of the text-mode CompuServe of December 1988, running today as a historical simulation. The calendar inside the service stays in December 1988. Fixed period collections carry a DECEMBER 1988 ARCHIVE label. Two things are deliberately modern and are labeled as such when you meet them: the current-news wire in Chapter 6, and the live weather and reference searches.

CHAPTER 1

1 Getting Connected — Your First Call

There are three ways to reach the service, and all three arrive at the same sign-on screen. Use whichever terminal you have at hand.

BY TELNET

Point any Telnet client at the public host on port 2323:

```
telnet compuserve-sim.duckdns.org 2323

... connection opens ...
Host Name: CIS
```

At the **Host Name** prompt, type `CIS` — or simply press Enter — to sign in. If you only want to look up dial-up access numbers first, type `PHONES` instead. The directory covers major cities in all 50 states, the District of Columbia, and Canadian centers. Search by city name (try `Portland, OR`), list everything with `ALL`, and read the sources with `SOURCES`. Every number is marked HISTORICAL or FICTIONAL; the directory displays numbers only — it does not dial them.

BY BROWSER OR LOCAL CONSOLE

The service also offers a browser terminal, which permits several simultaneous sessions, and a local console terminal for the machine it runs on. The browser terminal remembers your place: use the Up and Down arrow keys to recall earlier commands, **Save text** to download a transcript of your session, and the TOP, MENU, and OFF buttons when you would rather click than type.

YOUR USER ID AND PASSWORD

User IDs look like this: `70000,0001` — two numbers separated by a comma. Enter yours at the User ID prompt, then your password. Passwords are never shown as you type them, and they are stored only as salted hashes, never as plain text.

- **New here?** Enter an unused User ID and the service will offer to create a local account and set your password on that first sign-on.
- **Returning?** Your Forums, mail, drafts, and game records are waiting exactly where you left them.
- **Three strikes:** three failed password attempts lock the account until a SysOp unlocks it. Type carefully.

TERMINAL SETTINGS

Three period presets are built in: **C64** (40 columns, 1200 baud, scrolling), **IBM** (80 columns, 1200 baud, scrolling), and **MAC** (80 columns, 2400 baud, screen display). The full setup also controls 24-line pauses, sound, and a fast-output mode that removes the simulated character delay while keeping the historical screen layout. Control-S pauses output, Control-Q resumes it, and Control-C interrupts a transmission.

> **NOTE — GO START**
>
> Immediately after sign-in, type `GO START`. You will get three suggestions tailored to the simulated date — the fastest orientation a new member can get.

CHAPTER 2

2 The TOP Menu and GO Commands

Every session begins at TOP, the twelve-category map of the whole service. Type a number to enter a category, or jump straight to any service with a GO command — GO works at *any* prompt, including message readers, forms, the line editor, and CB.

```
CompuServe                          TOP

 1  Instructions/User Information
 2  Find a Topic
 3  Communications/Bulletin Bds.
 4  News/Weather/Sports
 5  Travel
 6  The Electronic MALL/Shopping
 7  Money Matters/Markets
 8  Entertainment/Games
 9  Home/Health/Family
10  Reference/Education
11  Computers/Technology
12  Business/Other Interests

Enter choice or GO command:
```

THE COMMANDS YOU WILL USE EVERY CALL

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`GO name` or `G name`	Go directly to a service, e.g. `GO MAIL`, `GO NEWS`, `GO TOP`
`T` / `M`	Return to the TOP menu / go back to the previous menu
`GO BACK` / `GO RECENT`	Retrace your path / pick from your last 10 destinations
`H` or `?`	Help — general, or for the service you are in
`R`	Resend (redisplay) the current page
`F` / `B` `N` / `P`	Page forward/back; next/previous menu item
`FIND words`	Search Forum messages, Library descriptions, classifieds, and Reference entries at once
`GO NEW`	The Activity Center: unread mail, Forum posts, orders, travel, and scheduled events in one list
`OFF` or `BYE`	Log off

GO words accept page addresses (such as `G CIS-1`) and unambiguous abbreviations of at least three letters. An unknown destination leaves you at the same prompt — nothing is lost, and a jump never submits a half-finished form. To find a destination by subject, use `GO INDEX` for topic search or `GO QUICK` for the searchable GO-word directory.

> **NOTE — IN THE GAMES**
>
> Inside an adventure game, `GO NORTH` walks north rather than jumping services. Everywhere else, GO is yours.

CHAPTER 3

3 EasyPlex Electronic Mail

EasyPlex is your mailbox. Type `GO MAIL` from anywhere to reach it. Mail is addressed by User ID, and the service keeps an Inbox and a Sent folder, flags unread messages on your welcome screen, offers a directory lookup when you know a name but not a number, and returns a Postmaster failure notice when a message cannot be delivered. Nothing in EasyPlex leaves the simulation — mail travels between members of this service only.

READING YOUR MAIL

Open the Inbox and select a message by number. From a message you can reply, forward, or delete it. Unread totals also appear in `GO NEW`, the Activity Center, so one glance after sign-in tells you whether anyone is waiting on you.

WRITING WITH LINEDIT

Composing a message uses the line editor, LINEDIT. Type your lines one at a time, then finish with one of these:

EDITOR COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`LIST`	Show the message as written so far
`DELETE n`	Remove line *n*
`REPLACE n text`	Replace line *n* with new text
`SAVE`	Finish and send
`ABORT`	Stop composing (your draft is kept — see below)

DRAFTS THAT SURVIVE A DROPPED LINE

Every change you make in LINEDIT is autosaved, in EasyPlex and in Forum composing alike. If your connection drops, or you enter `ABORT`, nothing is lost: start another composition and press `R` to resume the draft or `D` to delete it. `GO DRAFTS` opens the Personal Draft Center, where saved mail, new Forum posts, and Forum replies can be previewed, resumed directly, or deleted after confirmation. Unfinished drafts also appear in `GO NEW`. A draft disappears on its own only when the message is successfully sent or posted.

ALSO IN THIS CHAPTER'S NEIGHBORHOOD

Two reading services live alongside mail. `GO TIMELINE` opens a day-by-day history of December 1988 — browse with `F` and `B`, jump with `C`, search with `S`, and use `MARK id`, `MARKED`, and `DOWNLOAD` to build an attributed research packet. `GO FEATURES` opens five multi-day stories; move between chapters with `N` and `P`, save your place with `BOOKMARK`, and your reading position is remembered automatically. After sign-in, the TODAY IN 1988 briefing gathers the day's history, your unread totals, and live modern weather on one screen.

CHAPTER 4

4 Forums and Data Libraries

Forums are where the service talks back. The directory (`GO FORUMS`) lists 21 Forums, each organized the same way: Messages, Libraries, Conferencing, Announcements, a member directory, options, instructions, and membership. Learn one Forum and you have learned them all. Message areas offer SELECT, READ, CHANGE, and COMPOSE, and searches accept a message number, `FROM name`, or `SUBJECT words`.

READING AND JOINING IN

- Read a thread as a tree with `T number`; replies keep their parent message number, so a discussion reads in order.
- Watch a thread with `W` from its message actions, and stop watching with `U number`. Watched threads send EasyPlex notices when follow-ups arrive; check `GO NEW` on your next call.
- Six original Forum discussions unfold over simulated time, with replies after 2, 4, 8, and 24 simulated hours — read the competing suggestions, the original poster's test result, and the closing summary.
- Forum conferences run daily topics with persistent member identities, and transcripts are posted back to the Forum afterward.

THE COMPUTER FORUMS

Four machine-specific Forums sit at choices 7 through 10 of the directory. Each has three discussion sections, its own conference topic, and four real downloadable files — original simulation content, written for this service.

FORUM	JUMP	LIBRARY FILES
Commodore / Amiga	`GO C64`	DOCK64.BAS docking game, C64NOTES.TXT, AMIGALOG.TXT, PIXELCAT.TXT
Apple II	`GO APPLEII`	ORCHARD.BAS arithmetic practice, APPLETIP.TXT, DISKLOG.TXT, APPLEART.TXT
Atari ST	`GO ATARIST`	TEMPO.BAS duration calculator, STDESK.TXT, MIDIPLAN.TXT, STCLUB.TXT
DOS Software	`GO DOS`	CALLCOST.BAS, LOSTDISK.BAS text adventure, DOSNOTES.TXT, CLUBLIST.TXT

Enter a Forum and choose **2 Libraries**, or jump directly with `GO C64LIB`, `GO APPLELIB`, `GO STLIB`, or `GO DOSLIB`. Press `I number` to read a file's usage notes, version history, and a member review before you spend connect time on it. The BASIC listings are plain ASCII source: type or paste the numbered lines into the indicated BASIC interpreter.

DOWNLOADING AND UPLOADING

To download, enter the file number, then `B` for a CompuServe B transfer or `X` for XMODEM-style. Completed files land in the service's downloads area; in the browser terminal, a finished transfer starts a browser download, with a **Files ready** retry list under the terminal if your browser blocks it. Uploads are copied to a holding area and remain pending until a SysOp approves them. The IBM Hardware Forum (`GO IBMHW`) is the busiest technical Forum — and the home of the TERMLINK shareware project, reviewed with `GO TERMLINK`.

CHAPTER 5

5 The CB Simulator

The Citizens' Band Simulator is the service's live front porch: real-time conversation in channels, under handles, at 1988 speed. Type `GO CB` to walk in. Channels are shared live between everyone connected at the same time — console, browser, and Telnet callers all land in the same room, with the same scrollback and the same crowd.

```
CB Simulator — Channel: GENERAL
Present: ByteBender, NightOwlTX, ModemMan + 6

ModemMan: anyone got a 2400 baud init string
          that actually sticks?
ByteBender: AT&Z then check your IRQ, COM2
          fights everything on that bus

Type /WHO, /CHANNELS, or just talk.
```

CB COMMANDS

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
`/WHO`	See who is in the channel
`/CHANNELS`	List the channels
`/JOIN name`	Move to a channel — an unknown name creates a new member channel
`/MSG handle text`	Send a private message (it also lands in the recipient's Private Messages screen)
`/IGNORE handle`	Stop hearing from a handle
`/STATUS AVAILABLE`	Or `AWAY` or `BUSY` — set how you appear
`/INFO handle`	A simulated member's computer, interests, home Forum, and your last topic together
`/EXIT`	Leave CB

Arrival and departure notices are kept with the latest 20 messages, so you can catch up on what you missed. Anything typed without a leading slash is simply said out loud in the channel.

THE REGULARS

CB is also home to 34 clearly simulated period members, with seven to twelve present in a channel at a time. They are part of the recreation, and they behave like it: they remember topics you discussed before, answer when you address their handle directly, tailor technical replies to the subject and the computer you mention, drift between rooms, and keep quieter hours overnight. Try the period subjects — MODEM, DOS, MEMORY, GAME, WEATHER — and watch a conversation develop. `GO SOCIETY` opens the CB Society next door, with membership, Club Notes, and a persistent club discussion board.

> **NOTE — HANDLES ARE PUBLIC**
>
> Everything said in a channel is public to everyone in it, simulated regulars included. Keep private business in EasyPlex, and private remarks in `/MSG`.

CHAPTER 6

6 News, Magazine, and Reference

NEWS — TWO WIRES, CLEARLY LABELED

`GO NEWS` carries two separate wires, and the service never mixes them. News option 5 opens the **December 1988 period edition**: 64 authored dispatches across World, Business, Technology, and Science, presented twelve to an edition, with recently shown items held back so five consecutive editions contain no repeats. News option 6 refreshes the **current-news wire** — modern headlines from a live news feed, shown through the same period-style wire presentation, with source attribution and update timestamps. If a refresh fails, the previous headlines are preserved rather than lost.

ONLINE WEEKLY MAGAZINE

`GO MAGAZINE` (or `GO WEEKLY`) opens Online Weekly: five original issues written for December 1988. These are new articles in period dress, not reprints — settle in with them the way you would with the magazine that used to arrive with the bill.

REFERENCE DATA BASES

`GO REFERENCE` offers four classic databases of 50 records each — 200 records in all:

- **Academic American Encyclopedia**
- **Medical Information** — general historical-simulation information, not a diagnosis
- **Science and Technology Index**
- **Electronic Library**

Type words to search, `B` to browse the full index, or enter a record ID such as `L4003` directly. Results show twelve per page (page with `F` and `B`), and searches support `AND`, `OR`, and `NOT`. Entries carry SEE ALSO cross-references. Build a research packet as you go: `MARK id` the records that matter, review them with `MARKED`, and `DOWNLOAD` an ASCII packet of the set. `SUBJECTS` lists each database's subject index. Reference records are also swept into the global `FIND words` search.

A fifth choice, **Live General Reference**, searches the modern web encyclopedia and presents up to ten results in the same terminal style, labeled with `W` identifiers and clearly marked as modern content outside the December 1988 simulation. A companion live academic search returns scholarly works with authors, year, and citation counts; prefix a search with `BEFORE 1989` to keep it period. When the network is unavailable, the four offline databases remain fully usable.

CHAPTER 7

7 Games, Travel, Money, and Shopping

A survey chapter: four corners of the service worth an evening each. Every transaction in all four is fictional — no real money, bookings, or orders are involved anywhere.

GAMES — GO GAMES

Adventure: The Silent Mainframe is a multi-room puzzle. Use `LOOK`, compass directions, `TAKE item`, `INVENTORY`, `EXAMINE item`, `USE item`, `MAP`, and `SCORE`; `QUIT` leaves. Your wins and best move counts are kept. **MegaWars** keeps a separate ship career per member: Star Command missions earn credits and experience, from Cadet up to Commodore, with phasers, a limited missile magazine, and starbases for trading, repairs, and shield charging — `MAP` shows the nine-sector jump ring and `SAVE` holds your position. **Trivia Tournament** deals five-question rounds from a period-computing question bank and keeps your lifetime accuracy, streaks, and points. The **Online Adventure League** adds a persistent campaign character — Scout, Engineer, or Courier — with one quest per simulated day. Player Records on the Games menu summarizes all of it. Six arcade games round out the menu.

From December 12, the **Special Desk** may write with a research case: follow the CHIP-88 evidence through a Forum thread, the period business wire, a market report, and a Reference index, then decide what to do with what you found. `GO CASE` reviews your evidence ledger; the decision and its outcome are kept.

TRAVEL — GO TRAVEL

Variable 1988 airline schedules, hotels, and a Trip Folder that holds your fictional reservations. The Weather Operations Center tracks three fictional December storm systems; if one crosses your route, your reservation moves to an action-required state, an EasyPlex alert arrives, and you choose an alternate flight, protective rail routing, a hotel waitlist, standby, or cancellation under a weather waiver. A separate Live Weather Wire shows real current conditions and a three-day forecast, clearly separated from the fictional 1988 weather.

MONEY MATTERS — GO FINANCE

MicroQuote quotations, a personal portfolio, limit orders, and an Investment Club, all running on simulated prices that observe simulated weekends. An optional December Market Challenge measures your portfolio against a preserve-capital goal.

THE ELECTRONIC MALL — GO SHOP

The Comp-U-Store for fictional orders, and the Trading Post (`GO TRADINGPOST`) for member classifieds: post a listing for 21 days, send a seller an inquiry, and mark your own listing sold when it goes. `GO PROFILE` ties the personal side together — mail, Forum activity, trivia, library use, and order status in one summary.

CHAPTER 8

8 Personal Tools, Help, and Good Manners

STAYING ORGANIZED

- `GO CALENDAR` — one calendar for pending mail replies, order fulfillment, travel status, Forum follow-ups, trips, and classified expirations.
- `GO NOTEBOOK` — persistent notes. From any menu, `NOTE title | text` files a note tagged with the service you were in.
- `GO DOWNLOADS` — the Download Center: list, read, rename, or delete your generated ASCII files.
- `GO ACHIEVEMENTS` — your record across exploration, correspondence, research, trading, travel, shopping, and games.
- `GO PEOPLE` — your correspondents: the members and simulated regulars you exchange with most, and the standing of each relationship.
- `CAPTURE ON / OFF` — record your session to a file; `STATUS`, `VERSION`, and `DIAG` report on your session and setup.

GETTING HELP

- `H` anywhere, or `?` for help with the service you are in.
- `HELP topic` searches help — try `HELP TRAVEL` or `HELP TRADING`.
- `COMMANDS` lists the actions available right where you are.
- `GO HELP` opens the full instructions menu; `GO INDEX` searches topics.
- User Information holds your usage statement: connect time, baud rate, and the session's fictional charges, downloadable as a plain text file.

GOOD MANNERS ON THE SERVICE

Forums are public: be courteous, quote only what a reply needs, use descriptive subject lines, and search recent messages before posting a question. Libraries are for public-domain and shareware files — never upload copyrighted commercial software. In CB, remember the room is shared; take private business to EasyPlex.

APPENDIX

GO Word Directory — Quick Reference

Keep this page by the terminal. These are the jumps you will use most; the complete directory is searchable inside the service with `GO QUICK`, and `GO INDEX` finds destinations by topic. Remember that GO works at any prompt, abbreviations of three letters or more are accepted when they are unambiguous, and an unknown word simply leaves you where you are.

SERVICE	GO WORD	SERVICE	GO WORD
Top menu	`GO TOP`	EasyPlex mail	`GO MAIL`
Guided start	`GO START`	Draft Center	`GO DRAFTS`
Activity Center	`GO NEW`	CB Simulator	`GO CB`
Forum directory	`GO FORUMS`	News	`GO NEWS`
IBM Hardware Forum	`GO IBMHW`	Magazine	`GO MAGAZINE`
Commodore / Amiga	`GO C64`	Reference	`GO REFERENCE`
Apple II / Atari ST / DOS	`GO APPLEII` etc.	Games	`GO GAMES`
Finance	`GO FINANCE`	Travel	`GO TRAVEL`
Shopping	`GO SHOP`	Trading Post	`GO TRADINGPOST`
Weather	`GO WEATHER`	Personal profile	`GO PROFILE`
December 1988 timeline	`GO TIMELINE`	Feature stories	`GO FEATURES`
Special Desk case	`GO CASE`	TERMLINK project	`GO TERMLINK`

The full directory is searchable in the service itself with GO QUICK and GO INDEX. This manual describes the Classic CompuServe Simulation, version 1.17.0, an independent historical recreation of the text-mode service of December 1988. CompuServe names and historical service names are used descriptively. All charges, orders, reservations, quotations, and transactions in the simulation are fictional. Happy connecting — and mind your connect time, even when it costs nothing.